Hon MEC SIBULELE NGONGO
Dept of Sport, Recreation, Arts and Culture

LIBRARIES OF THE FUTURE EXPO

South African Library Week 2026
Provincial Celebrations
East London Convention Centre, KuGompo City -BCM.

"RECLAIMING KNOWLEDGE EMPOWERING FUTURES"

16-18 March 2026 Starting @ 08:30 Daily

Time	Item	Speaker(s)
DAY ONE		
08:30 – 09:00	Registration & Networking Tea	
	NATIONAL ANTHEM	
PROGRAMME Director		Azola Vanda Voice Lounge) Ms. Vee
09:05 – 09:15	Opening & Welcome Remarks	Mayor: BCM
09:15 – 09:30	Purpose of the SALW EXPO	HOD: DSRAC
09:30 – 10:00	Leva Foundation: Robotics and Coding	Prof Jean Greyling (Nelson Mandela University)
10:00 – 10:05	Introduction of the MEC	
10:05 – 10:30	Keynote Address	Honourable MEC (DSRAC)
10:30 – 11:45	**Panel Discussion** **"Libraries in a Digital Age"**	Ndende Technologies Hauwei Universal Knowledge Systems Deviare
11:45 – 12:00	**Summation**	Dr Bitso
12:00 – 13:00	Official Opening of the EXPO (Exhibition Walkabout)	
13:00 – 14:00	LUNCH BREAK LUNCH BREAK	
14:00 – 16:00	Breakaway Sessions	
14:00 – 14:30	Digital Literacy and AI	WSU
14:30 – 15:00	AI Public Libraries and the future	Dr S Ndlovu UFH
15:00 – 16:30	Digital Literacy and Lifelong Learning" – Exploring programs that empower communities to develop digital skills.	Session Chairs NLSA Nokuthula Ndlovu
15:00 – 16:30	"Libraries as Cultural and Community Hubs" – Showcasing libraries as spaces for local culture, storytelling, and community events.	Session Chairs DSRAC Monwabisi Kobese
16:30 – 17:00	Closing	Programme Director Announcements

Time	Item	Speaker(s)
DAY TWO		
08:30 – 09:00	Registration & Networking Tea	
09:05 – 09:15	Opening & Welcome	PROGRAMME Director
09:15 – 09:30	Libraries of the future presentation	UFH Library
09:30 – 10:00	Lexi, Sebueng and Lebone	North West University
10:00 – 11:00	Guest speaker:	Prof M Modiba (UNISA)
11:00 – 12:30	**Panel Discussion: Artificial Intelligence**	Telkom SA Vodacom Sabinet CSX NLSA
12:30 – 13:00	**Summation**	Chairperson EC Library Council
Official Opening of the EXPO Exhibition Walkabout		
13:00 – 14:00	LUNCH BREAK LUNCH BREAK	
14:00 – 16:00	Breakaway Sessions	
14:00 – 14:45	Training the Transformers: Building AI Competencies for Librarians in the Global South.	Ms. Sibongiseni Mrwashu University of Fort Hare
14:45 – 15:15	Lightbulb	Telkom SA
15:15 – 15:45	City of Joburg eLearning platform	Mr. J Nyoka and Ben Ramela
15:55 – 16:30	DREAM CITY APP	Mr Mavimbela
16:30 – 17:00	Closing Announcements	Programme Director

Time	Item	Speaker(s)
DAY THREE		
08:30 – 09:00	Registration & Networking Tea	
09:05 – 09:15	Opening & Welcome	Programme Director
09:15 – 09:55	Feedback from commissions	Nokuthula Ndlovu/Monwabisi Kobese
10:00 – 11:00	Handover of Digital Equipment to Mdantsane NU14 and KwaBhaca Library	MEC
	Kirkwood Public Library Special Award for Winning LIASA Library of the Year	MEC
11:00 – 11:15	Vote of Thanks	Mayor
	Parallel	
	Training Sessions	
09:00 – 11:30	Masterclass titled The Superhuman Librarian: AI, Knowledge and the Library of the Future	Deviare
11:45 – 12:55	Building Strong Reading Communities: Strategy, Implementation & PIMS Reporting	Librarian of the Year Ms. Linda Ntaka
LUCH TIME		13:00-14:00

'A United, Active and Winning Province Through Sport, Recreation, Arts, Culture & Heritage'

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Province of the EASTERN CAPE EDUCATION
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